

Essays in Empirical Finance

A thesis submitted to The University of Manchester
for the degree of PhD
in the Faculty of Humanities.

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Avery L. Reader

Alliance Manchester Business School, MSM

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List of Tables

Chapter 1

Preface

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Chapter 2

List of publications

Reader, Avery. & Co-author, A. (2026). *Title of the first paper*. Journal Name, in press.

Reader, Avery., Co-author, A. & Co-author, B. (2026). *Title of the second paper*. Manuscript under review.

Reader, Avery. & Co-author, C. (2026). *Title of the third paper*. Manuscript in preparation.

Chapter 3

Abstract

The University of Manchester

Avery L Reader

PhD

Essays in Empirical Finance

2027

Write your abstract here. The University policy (section 8.1.e) requires that the abstract not exceed one page; aim for under 350 words at 12pt with 1.5 line spacing. State the research question, the methodological approach, the principal findings, and the contribution.

Chapter 4

Declaration of originality

I declare that no portion of the work referred to in this thesis has been submitted in support of an application for another degree or qualification of this or any other university or other institute of learning.

Chapter 5

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Chapter 6

Acknowledgements

Write your acknowledgements here. Policy section 9.1.b allows a dedication and acknowledgements after the compulsory preliminary pages. Acknowledgements do not count toward the main-text word limit.

Part I

Main body

Chapter 7

Introduction

7.1 Research objectives and motivation

State the motivation for the research and the overarching question(s) the thesis addresses.

7.2 Thesis overview

Provide an overview of the three constituent papers and how they relate to one another. Per policy section 13.10, include here the rationale for submitting in journal format and an account of how the thesis has been constructed.

7.3 Thesis structure

Summarise the structure of the remaining chapters.

References

Add the references cited in this introduction. Each paper chapter also carries its own References section at the end.

Chapter 8

Title of the first paper

Preface

Contribution statement

Briefly describe the candidate's contribution to this paper, e.g.: I designed the study, collected the data, performed the analysis, and wrote the manuscript. Co-author A advised on the methodology.

State the publication status of the paper here (e.g., *published in Journal Name, 2024*; *under review at Journal Name*; *in preparation*).

8.1 Introduction

8.2 Background and related literature

8.3 Data

8.4 Methodology

8.5 Results

8.6 Robustness tests

8.7 Conclusions

References

Insert the references cited in this paper.

Appendices

8.8 2.A Supplementary material

Chapter 9

Title of the second paper

Preface

Contribution statement

Briefly describe the candidate's contribution to this paper.

State the publication status of the paper here.

9.1 Introduction

9.2 Literature review

9.3 Methodology

9.4 Data

9.5 Results

9.6 Robustness tests

9.7 Conclusions

References

Insert the references cited in this paper.

Appendices

9.8 3.A Supplementary material

Chapter 10

Title of the third paper

Preface

Contribution statement

Briefly describe the candidate's contribution to this paper.

State the publication status of the paper here.

10.1 Introduction

10.2 Literature review

10.3 Methodology

10.4 Data

10.5 Results

10.6 Conclusions

References

Insert the references cited in this paper.

Appendices

10.7 4.A Supplementary material

Chapter 11

Conclusions

11.1 Implications and future research

Summarise the implications of the three papers and outline directions for future research.

11.2 Summary

Provide a brief summary of the overall contribution of the thesis.

References

Insert the references cited in this conclusion.